



STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles >

Graph Transformations

A-level Maths Topic Summaries - Functions

Subject & topics: Maths | Functions | General Functions **Stage & difficulty:** A Level P2

Fill in the blanks to complete the summary notes on graph transformations.

Part A

Graph transformations

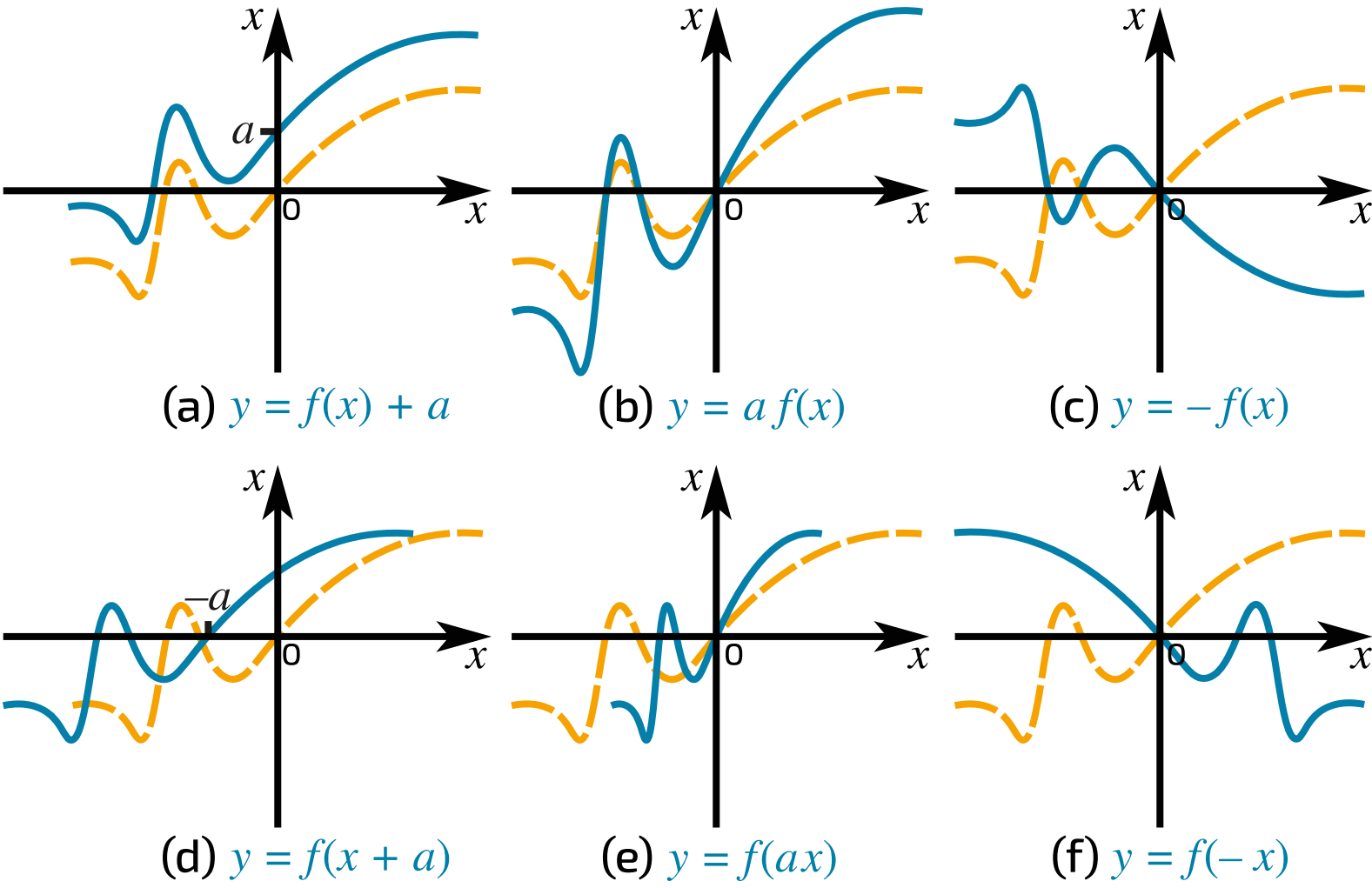


Figure 1: Transformations of the function $y = f(x)$. In each case the original function is the dashed yellow line, and the transformed function is the solid blue line.

Complete the table to describe the following transformations of the function $y = f(x)$.

Transformation	Description
$f(x) + a$	parallel to the by
$af(x)$	parallel to the by scale factor
$-f(x)$	in the
$f(x + a)$	parallel to the by
$f(ax)$	parallel to the by scale factor
$f(-x)$	in the

Items:

reflection

stretch

translation

x-axis

y-axis

-a

$\frac{1}{a}$

a

Part B

Order of transformations

If a function is translated and stretched parallel to the same axis, the order in which the transformations are carried out is important. This is illustrated in **Figure 2** and **Figure 3**.

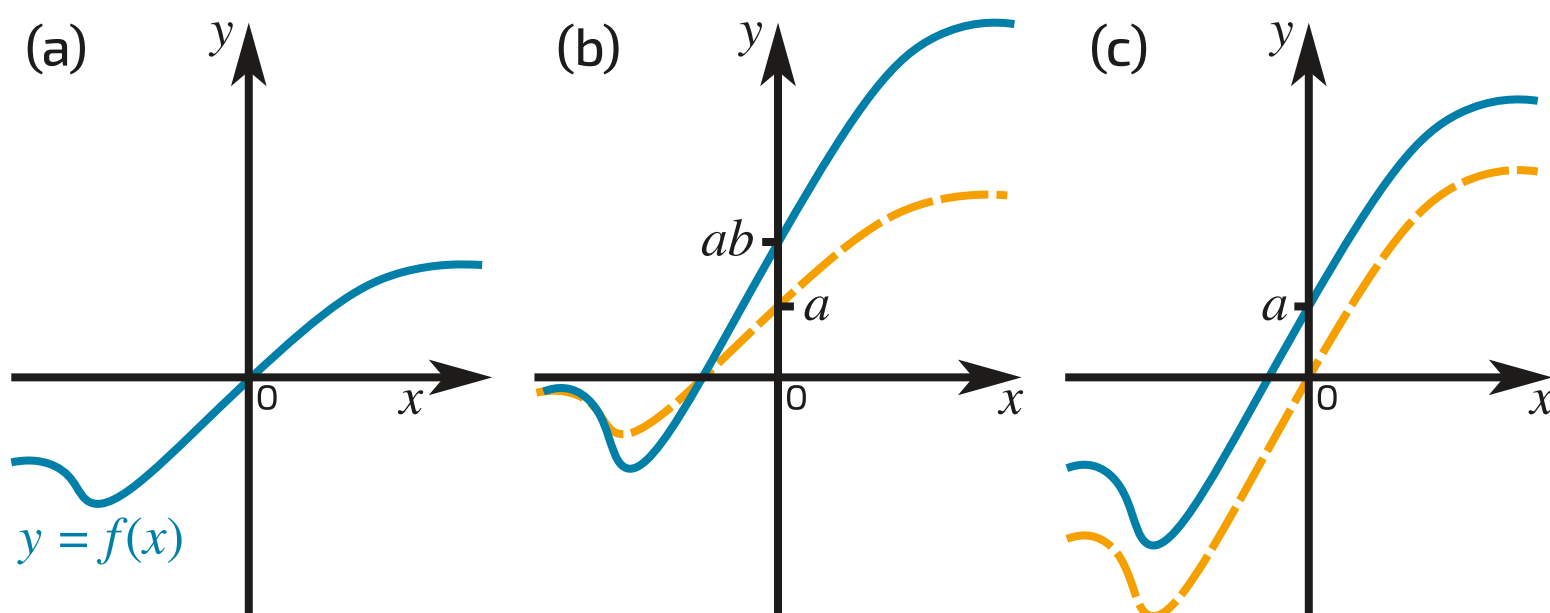


Figure 2: Transformations parallel to the y -axis. (a) Original function. (b) Translation by a (yellow dashed line) followed by stretch by b (blue line). (c) Stretch by b (yellow dashed line) followed by translation by a (blue line).

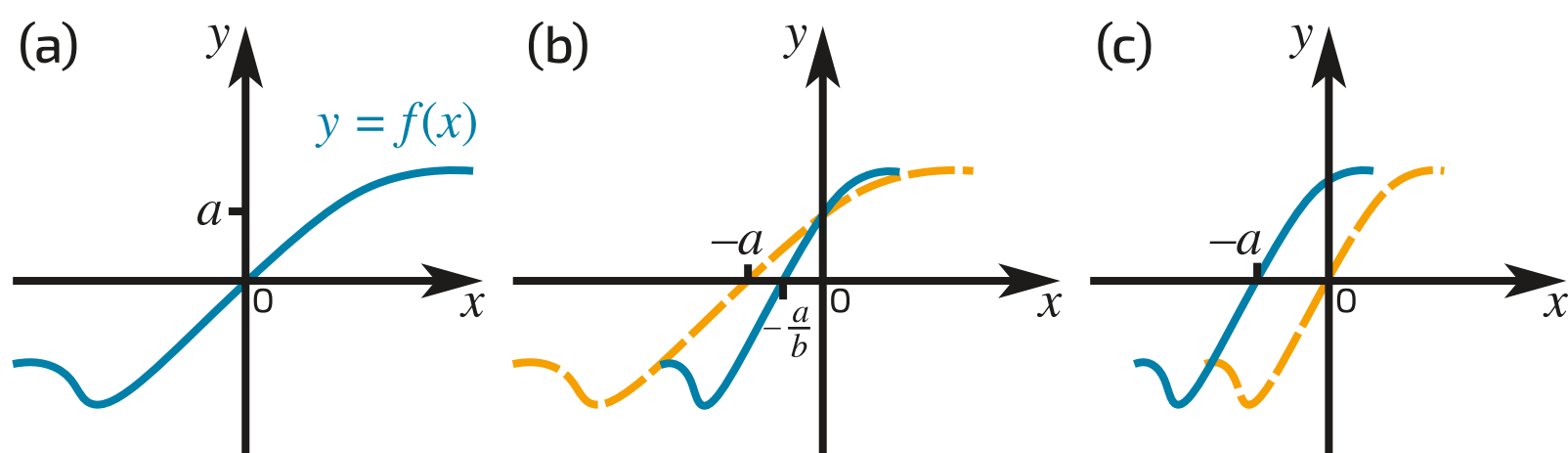


Figure 3: Transformations parallel to the x -axis. (a) Original function. (b) Translation by $-a$ (yellow dashed line) followed by stretch by $\frac{1}{b}$ (blue line). (c) Stretch by $\frac{1}{b}$ (yellow dashed line) followed by translation by $-a$ (blue line).

Use the diagrams above to help you complete these notes on transformation order.

Transformations parallel to the y -axis

Stretch by scale factor a followed by translation by b :

$$f(x) \rightarrow af(x) \rightarrow \boxed{}$$

Translation by b followed by stretch by scale factor a :

$$f(x) \rightarrow f(x) + b \rightarrow \boxed{}$$

Transformations parallel to the x -axis

Stretch by scale factor $\frac{1}{a}$ followed by translation by $-b$:

$f(x) \rightarrow f(ax) \rightarrow$

Translation by $-b$ followed by stretch by scale factor $\frac{1}{a}$:

$f(x) \rightarrow f(x + b) \rightarrow$

Items:

-
-
-
-

Created for isaacscience.org by Jonathan Waugh

Question deck:
STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles



Transformations of Graphs 2ii

Subject & topics: Maths Stage & difficulty: A Level P1

Part A

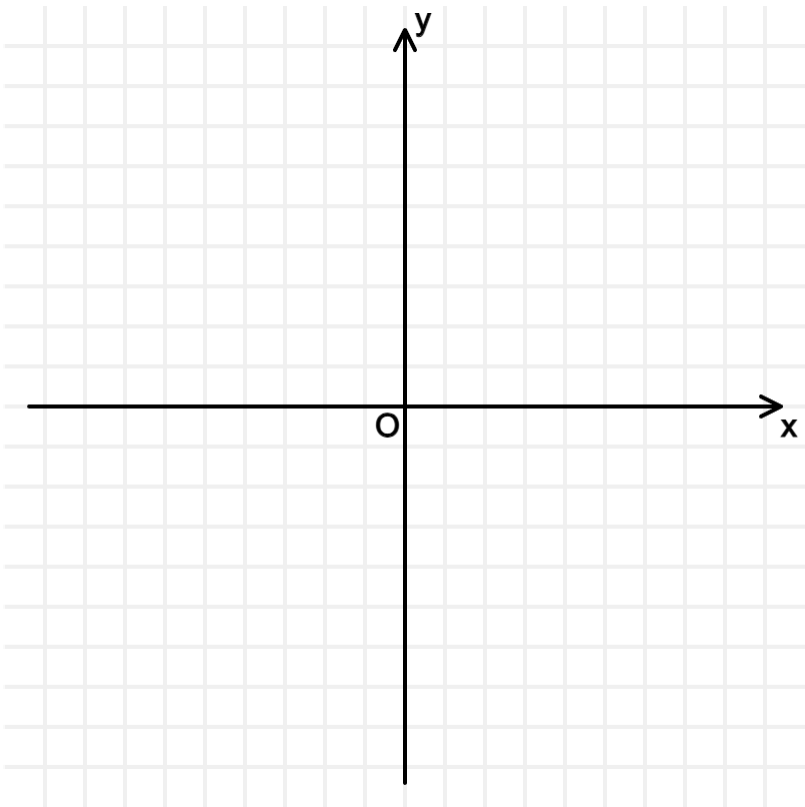
Sketch the curve $y = \frac{1}{x}$

Sketch the curve $y = \frac{1}{x}$.

Part B

Sketch the curve $y = x^4$

Sketch the curve $y = x^4$.



Part C

Transformation from $y = x^3$ onto $y = 8x^3$

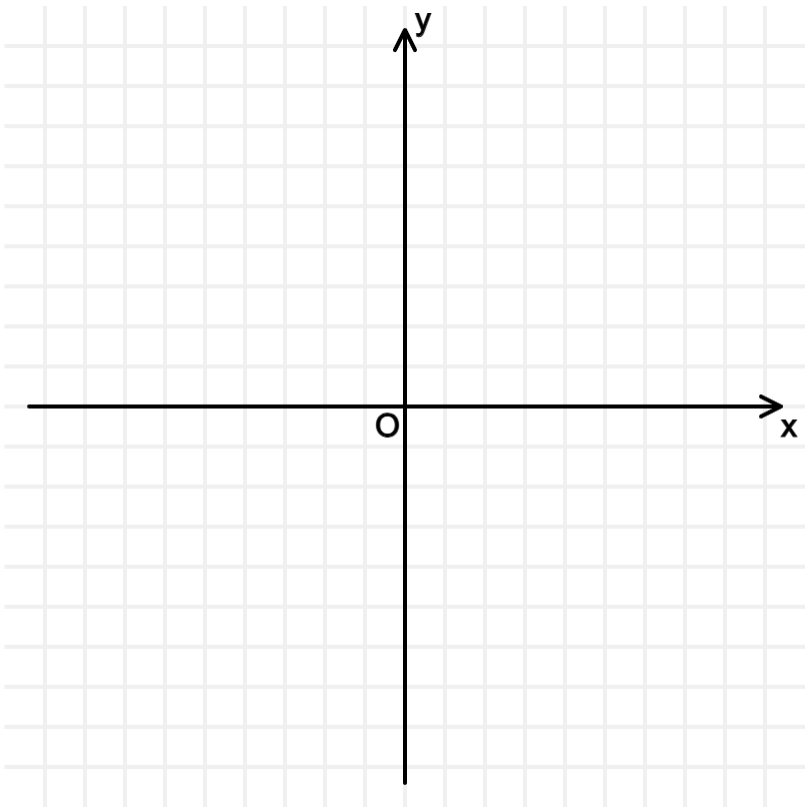
Which TWO of the following describe a single transformation that maps the curve $y = x^3$ onto the curve $y = 8x^3$?

- ☐ A stretch of scale factor 8 parallel to the y -axis
- ☐ A translation +8 units parallel to the y -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor $\frac{1}{8}$ parallel to the y -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor $\frac{1}{8}$ parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor $\frac{1}{2}$ parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor 8 parallel to the x -axis.

Part D

Sketch the curve $y = -\frac{1}{x}$

Sketch the curve $y = -\frac{1}{x}$.



Part E

State the equation

The curve $y = -\frac{1}{x}$ is translated by $+2$ units parallel to the x -axis in the positive direction. State the equation of the transformed curve.

The following symbols may be useful: x , y

Part F

Transformation from $y = -\frac{1}{x}$ onto $y = -\frac{1}{3x}$

Which TWO of the following describe a single transformation that maps the curve $y = -\frac{1}{x}$ onto the curve $y = -\frac{1}{3x}$?

- ☐ A stretch of scale factor $\frac{1}{3}$ parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor 3 parallel to the y -axis.
- ☐ A translation by +3 units parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor 3 parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor $\frac{1}{3}$ parallel to the y -axis.

Used with permission from UCLES, A level, June 2007, Paper 4721 Question 2 and June 2015, Paper 4721, Question 2.

Question deck:

STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles



STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles >

Transformations of Graphs 3ii

Subject & topics: Maths Stage & difficulty: A Level P1

The graph of $y = f(x)$ for $-2 \leq x \leq 2$ is shown in **Figure 1**.

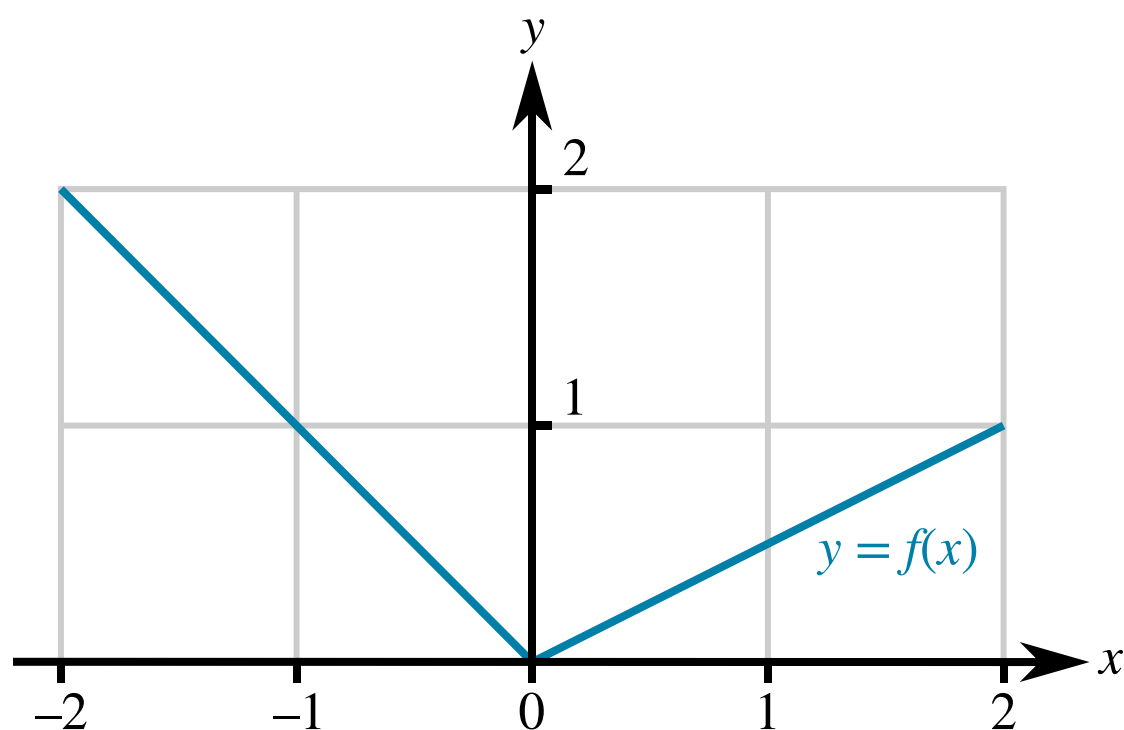


Figure 1: The graph of $y = f(x)$ for $-2 \leq x \leq 2$.

Part A

Sketch $y = f(-x)$

Sketch the curve $y = f(-x)$ for $-2 \leq x \leq 2$.

What is the y -value of the curve $y = f(-x)$ when $x = 1$?

The following symbols may be useful: y

Part B

Sketch $y = f(-x) + 2$

Sketch the curve $y = f(-x) + 2$ for $-2 \leq x \leq 2$.

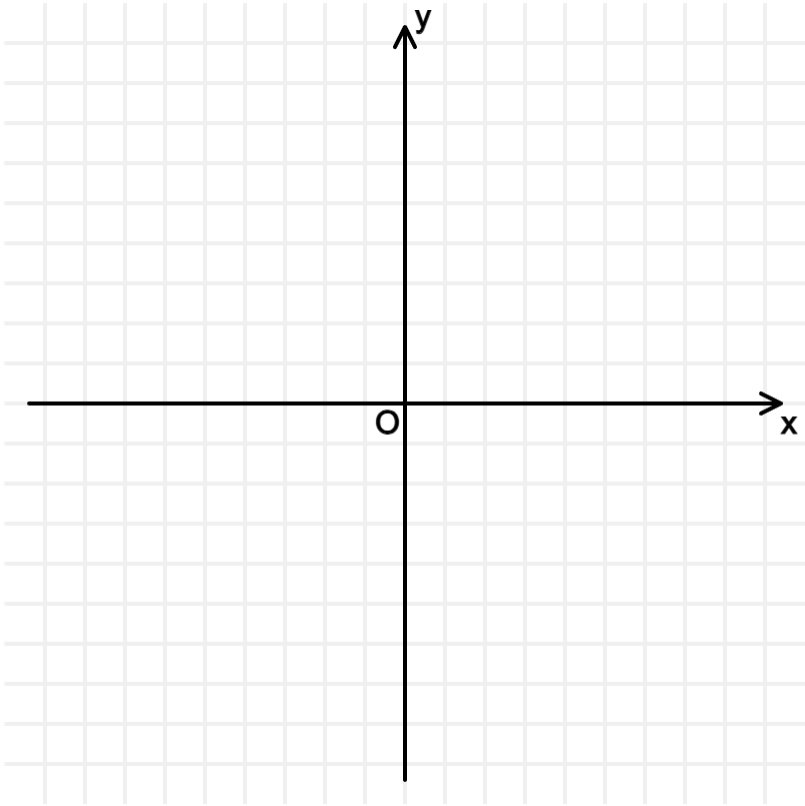
What is the y -value of the curve $y = f(-x) + 2$ when $x = -2$?

The following symbols may be useful: y

Part C

Sketch $y = -\frac{1}{x^2}$

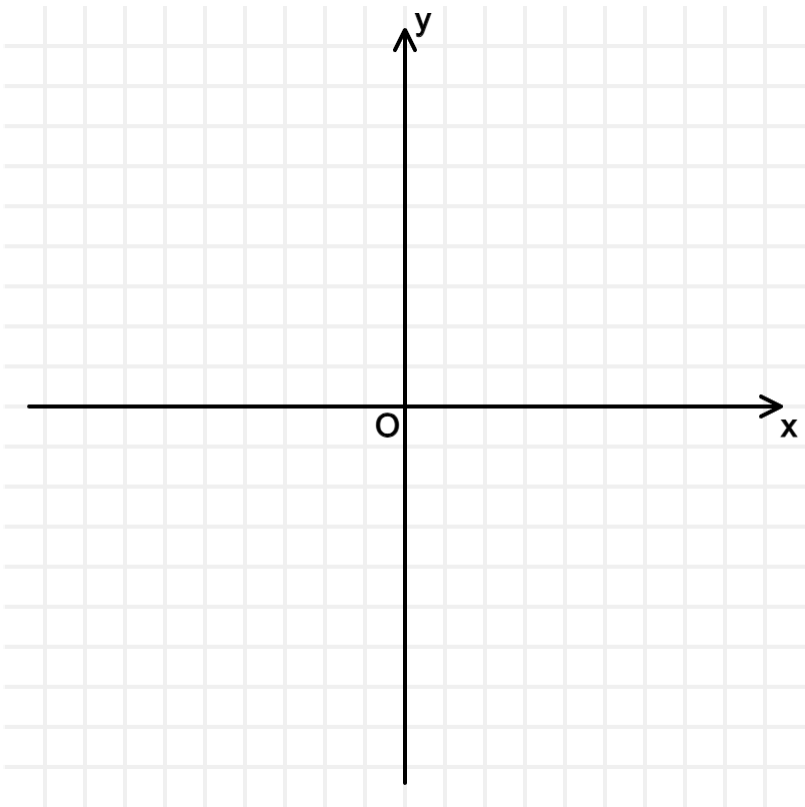
Sketch the curve $y = -\frac{1}{x^2}$.



Part D

Sketch $y = 3 - \frac{1}{x^2}$

Sketch the curve $y = 3 - \frac{1}{x^2}$.



Part E

State the equation

The curve $y = -\frac{1}{x^2}$ is stretched parallel to the y -axis by scale factor 2. State the equation of the transformed curve.

The following symbols may be useful: x , y

Used with permission from UCLES, A level, January 2012, Paper 4721, Question 2 and June 2010, Paper 4721, Question 2.

Question deck:
STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles



Question

Transformations of Graphs 1i

Subject & topics: Maths Stage & difficulty: A Level P2

Part A

Sketch y

Find the roots of the curve $y = x^2(3 - x)$ and sketch it.

Part B**Translate y**

The curve $y = x^2(3 - x)$ is translated by two units in the positive direction parallel to the x axis.

State the equation of the curve after this transformation.

The following symbols may be useful: x , y

Part C**Find transformation of y**

Which of these describes the transformation of the curve $y = x^2(3 - x)$ to $y = \frac{1}{2}x^2(3 - x)$?

- ☐ A stretch of scale factor 2 parallel to the y -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor 2 parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor $\frac{1}{2}$ parallel to the y -axis.
- ☐ A stretch of scale factor $\frac{1}{2}$ parallel to the x -axis.

Part D**Vertical translation of $f(x)$**

The curve $y = f(x)$ passes through the point P with coordinates (2, 5).

State the coordinates of the point corresponding to P on the curve $y = f(x) + 2$.

(,)

Part E**Lateral stretching of $f(x)$**

The curve $y = f(x)$ passes through the point P with coordinates (2, 5).

State the coordinates of the point corresponding to P on the curve $y = f(2x)$.

(,)

Part F**Find transformation of $f(x)$**

Which of the following describes the single transformation that maps the curve $y = f(x)$ onto $y = f(x + 4)$?

- ☐ A translation of -4 units parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A translation of -4 units parallel to the y -axis.
- ☐ A translation of 4 units parallel to the x -axis.
- ☐ A translation of 4 units parallel to the y -axis.

Used with permission from UCLES, A level, June 2016, Paper 4721, Question 7 and June 2014, Paper 4721, Question 4.



STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles >

Lateral and Vertical Translations

Pre-Uni Maths for Sciences E2.6

Subject & topics: Maths | Functions | General Functions

Stage & difficulty: A Level P2

Investigate the transformations of the following functions.

Part A

Lateral translation

Consider the function $f(x) = x^2 + 2x + 1$. The function $g(x) = f(x - a)$, where a is a positive constant. If $g(1) = 9$, find the value of a .

If the value is not a whole number, enter the value as a decimal.

$a =$

Part B

Vertical translation

Consider the function $r(u) = \frac{2}{u - 2}$. The function $s(u) = r(u) + b$, where b is a constant. If $s(0) = 1$, find the value of b .

If the value is not a whole number, enter the value as a decimal.

$b =$

Part C

Lateral and vertical translation

Consider the function $p(r) = \frac{1}{r}$. The function $q(r) = p(r - c) + d$, where c and d are constants. If $q(0) = 1$ and $q(2) = 3$, find the values of c and d .

If a value is not a whole number, enter the value as a decimal.

$c =$

$d =$

Created for isaacphysics.org by Julia Riley

Question deck:

STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and

Circles



STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles >

Reflection and Symmetry

Pre-Uni Maths for Sciences E2.10

Subject & topics: Maths | Functions | General Functions

Stage & difficulty: A Level C2

The following questions ask you to deduce the symmetry properties of a number of functions. There are three choices:

- even - a function for which $f(x) = f(-x)$ which is also described as being symmetric about the vertical axis,
- odd - a function for which $f(x) = -f(-x)$ which is also described as being antisymmetric about the vertical axis (or symmetric about zero),
- neither even nor odd.

Where relevant you may assume that a and b are non-zero constants.

Part A

Even functions

Decide which of the following functions are even.

- ☐ $a(x + b)^2$
- ☐ $(x - a)(x + a)$
- ☐ $a \cos x$
- ☐ $\frac{a}{x^2} + b$
- ☐ ax^2
- ☐ $ax^2 + bx^4$
- ☐ $ax^2 + b$
- ☐ $x^2(a + bx)$
- ☐ $a \sin x$
- ☐ $\frac{a}{x^2} + bx^2$
- ☐ $(x - a)(x + b) (a \neq b)$

Part B

Odd functions

Decide which of the following functions are odd.

☐ $x(a + bx^2)$

☐ $x^{\frac{1}{3}}$

☐ $a \tan x$

☐ $\frac{a}{x} + bx^3$

☐ ax

☐ $x^2(a + bx)$

☐ $(x + a)^{\frac{1}{3}}$

☐ $\frac{a}{x} + b$

☐ $\frac{a}{x}$

☐ $\frac{a}{x} + \frac{b}{x^3}$

☐ $a \sin x$

Part C

Neither odd nor even functions

Decide which of the following functions are neither odd nor even.

☐ $(x - a)(x + a)^2$

☐ $(x - a)(x + a)$

☐ $ax - b$

☐ $ax^{\frac{1}{2}}$

☐ $x(ax^2 + b)$

☐ $a\left(\frac{1}{x^2} - \frac{1}{b^2}\right)$

☐ $a(b - x)^{\frac{1}{2}}$

☐ $x^2(ax + b)$

☐ $\cos x + \sin x$

☐ $a \tan(x + 45^\circ)$

☐ $\frac{a}{(x - b)^2}$

Created for isaacphysics.org by Julia Riley

Question deck:

STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles



STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles >

Circles 1ii

Subject & topics: Maths **Stage & difficulty:** A Level P1

The circle with equation $x^2 + y^2 - 6x - k = 0$ has radius 4.

The points $A(3, a)$ and $B(-1, 0)$ lie on the circumference of the circle, with $a > 0$.

Part A

Centre

By completing the square for x and y find the coordinates of the centre of the circle.

(,)

Part B

Value of k

Find the value of k .

The following symbols may be useful: k

Part C

Length AB

Calculate the length of AB, giving your answer in simplified surd form.

Part D
Equation

Find the equation of the line **AB**. Give your answer in the form $y = mx + c$.

The following symbols may be useful: x , y

Used with permission from UCLES, A level, June 2007, Paper 4721, Question 9.

Question deck:
STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles



STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles >

Circles 3ii

Subject & topics: Maths **Stage & difficulty:** A Level P1

A circle has centre $(3, 1)$ and radius 5, and a line has equation $y = 2x$.

Part A

Circle equation

Write down the equation of the circle.

The following symbols may be useful: x , y

Part B

Intersection points

Find the coordinates of the points of intersection of the line and the circle.

(,)

Part C

Point on the line

Find the coordinates of the point on the line which is closest to the centre of the circle.

(,)

Used with permission from UCLES, A level, January 2010, Paper 4721, Question 8.

Question deck:

STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles



STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles >

Circles 2i

Subject & topics: Maths Stage & difficulty: A Level P1

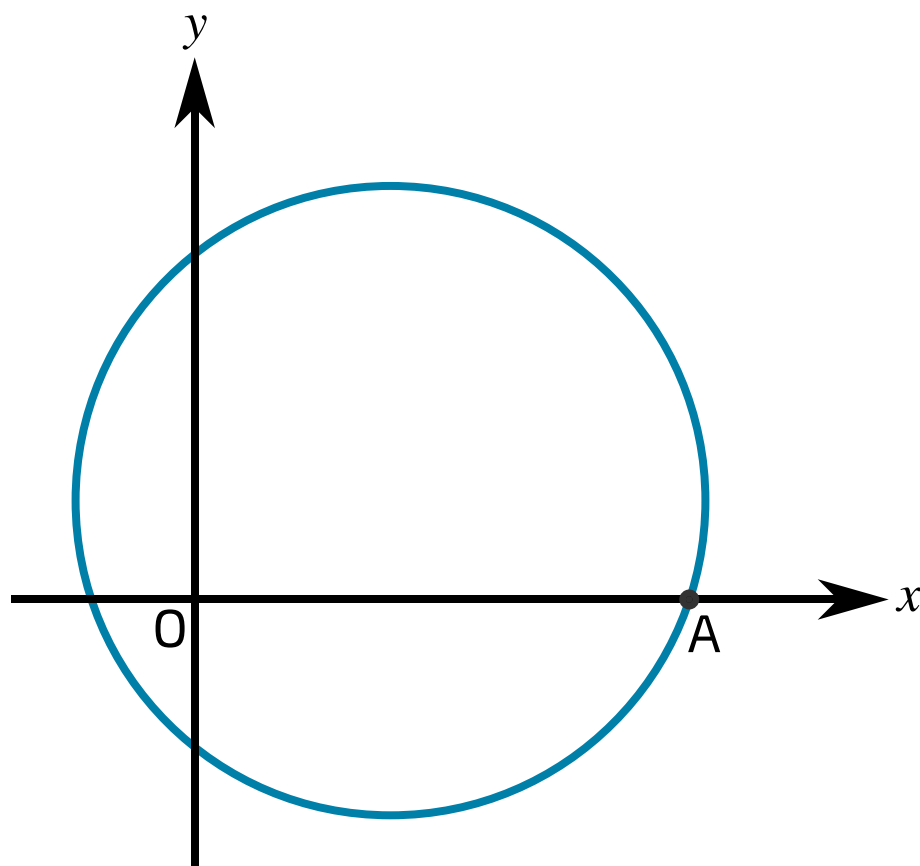


Figure 1: The circle with equation $x^2 + y^2 - 8x - 6y - 20 = 0$.

Figure 1 shows the circle with equation $x^2 + y^2 - 8x - 6y - 20 = 0$. The circle crosses the positive x axis at point A.

Part A

Find centre

By completing the square for x and y find the coordinates of the centre of the circle.

(,)

Part B**Find radius**

Find the radius of the circle.

Part C**Tangent to the circle at A**

Find the equation of the tangent to the circle at A. Give your answer in the form $y = mx + c$.

The following symbols may be useful: x , y

Part D**Another tangent to the circle**

A second tangent to the circle is parallel to the tangent at A. Find the equation of this second tangent in the form $y = mx + c$.

The following symbols may be useful: x , y

Part E

Find a radius

Another circle has its centre at the origin O and radius r . This circle lies wholly inside the first circle and $r > 0$. Find the upper bound for r . Give your answer as an inequality.

The following symbols may be useful: $<$, $\leq$, $>$, $\geq$, r

Adapted with permission from UCLES, A level, June 2016, Paper 4721, Question 10.

Question deck:

STEM SMART Single Maths 18 - Graph Transformations and Circles